
1 Password Policies

Summary

Menu	System administration → User administration → Password policies
Transaction code	usrar
Function authorization	usrar.*

Usage

Use the password policies to change password-related security settings of the system and to adapt them to the policies.

Field descriptions - password policies

Force password history

Used passwords will be recorded to force the user to select a new password. The user may only re-use an old password as soon as it is no longer included in the password history. In case of 5 saved passwords the user could thus only re-use the 1st selected one upon the 6th password change.

Maximum password age

Indicates for how many days a password will be valid. Prior to the termination of the password, the user will be requested to change the password.

Minimum password length

A password can have between 0 and 10 characters. A setting of 0 means that the user account doesn't need a password. Passwords, which are too long, are not very user-friendly. This includes also the risk that passwords will be saved at the workplace.

Password must include at least.... letters, numbers, and special indicators

One method to unlawfully detect passwords is an automatic testing with words from the wealth of words of a language. To prevent this, passwords must consist of a minimum amount of letters, numbers and special indicators. The sum of this amount must be higher than the minimum password length.

Allowed characters in the password

It can be defined here of which character pool a password can be formed.

Field descriptions - options

Password is case sensitive

Used to define whether the password check will be case-sensitive. If this field is not selected, a user with the password Li2Ps+- for example may also log in with the password li2ps+-.

Password change when user logs on for the first time

If this option is selected, the system will force the user, who logs in for the first time, to change his/her password.

Password must not contain user name

This is used to direct that the user log-on must not be used for the password, i.e. that a user "hans" will not be able to use a password such as "hans" or "12hans".

Exclusion of character strings from negative list

If this option is selected, another check will be executed during the assignment of the password and/or in the "Change password" dialog. A valid password can therefore not include a string that was registered by the 'Passwords' function exclusion list (see below).

Field description - account lockout policies

Threshold for blocking an account

The threshold for blocking an account defines how often a user is permitted to enter a wrong password before the relevant account will be blocked. If this policy is activated, the values of the "Block account for" and "Reset account blocking counter" can be set.

Block account for

The policy 'Block account for' is used to define for how many minutes an account will be blocked. The setting 0 will keep the user account blocked until the administrator unlocks it. This offers the advantage that the administrator can ask the user whether the user himself caused the account's blocking. To the extent that the user is not responsible for the blocking of the account, there might have been unauthorized attempts to log in by another "user" using this account. This will warn the administration that unauthorized persons try to use the system.

Reset account blocking counter

Incorrect log-on attempts will be reset to 0 after a certain period of time. If for example a user successfully logs in after two failed attempts, the account blocking counter will be set to 2. As soon as the threshold for blocking an account is set to 3, the user will only have one attempt to log in before the account will be blocked. If a period of time of 30 minutes is defined for the resetting of the account blocking counter, the user will have again 3 new attempts to log in after this period has elapsed. The time defined here must be shorter than the time set in the field 'Block account for'.